Sunday School Department • Proclaiming God's Word World Wide

SUNDAY SCHOOL MANUAL

HOLINESS

Memory Verse: 1 Peter 1:16

Text: Heb. 12:14 | 1 Pet. 1:14–16 | 1 Cor. 3:16–17 | Lev. 19:2

Sunday, 18th October 2026

INTRODUCTION

According to 1 Peter 1:16, God desired holiness from His people (children). In the time of the law, God commanded the high priest to wear on his forehead a **"golden plate"** bearing the word **"Holiness Unto the Lord"** which signifies that holiness is the offering God desires from His people because God Himself is Holy and He still desires and requires it from His people. Holiness is not merely about going to church, wearing decent clothes, or avoiding certain people. It begins in the heart and is demonstrated through our thoughts, words, actions, attitudes and relationship with others.

WHAT IS HOLINESS?

Holiness means being set apart for God and living according to His will. It involves separation from sin and dedication to God's purpose. *(Lev. 20:26; 2 Cor. 7:1; Rom. 12:1–2)*

In Hebrew language **(Qodesh/Qadosh)** means to be cut off, unique, distinct or consecrated.

In Greek **(Hagios)** — used in the New Testament; it describes something or someone sacred, morally blameless and dedicated to God's service.

WHY MUST WE BE HOLY?

1. **Because God Himself is Holy** *(1 Pet. 1:16; Lev. 19:2)*
2. **It is a requirement to see God and for fellowship with God** *(Heb. 12:14)*
3. **Because we are called to be the light of the world** — Our conduct and actions should point others towards God. *(Matt. 5:14–16)*
4. **It is necessary for resurrection from the dead and acceptability as sons of God** *(Rom. 1:4)*
5. **Holiness is His nature and He made us in His image and likeness** *(Gen. 1:27)*

HOW TO LIVE A HOLY LIFE

How we can live a life that is set apart for God:

1. **Through the Word of God** *(Psalm 119:9, 11)*
2. **Through the Help of the Holy Spirit** — The Holy Spirit helps to resist sinful desires and develop godly character. *(Gal. 5:16, 22–23)*
3. **Through Prayer** *(Matt. 26:41)*
4. **Through our Obedience to God** *(John 14:15)*
5. **Through Faith** *(Rom. 5:1–2)*

BENEFITS OF HOLINESS

1. **It brings us closer to God in fellowship** *(James 4:8; 1 John 1:3)*
2. **It gives good report (testimony)** *(1 Pet. 2:11–12)*
3. **It builds our spiritual life**

4. **It prepares us for resurrection**

5. **It enhances fellowship with other sons of God**

CONCLUSION

Holiness is God's call to every believer. It is not merely outward religious appearance or church doctrine. It is a life of separation from sin, dedication to God, and continual transformation into the likeness and image of Jesus Christ.

> **Memory Verse:** *"But as he which hath called you is holy, so be ye holy in all manner of conversation; Because it is written, Be ye holy; for I am holy."*
> **— 1 Peter 1:15–16 (KJV)**